



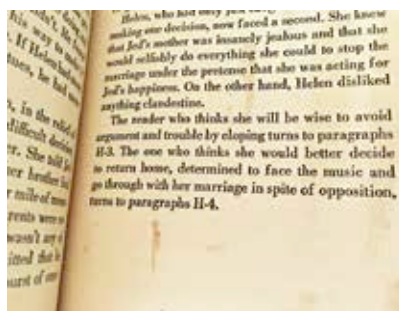
Ducati electric bike

Ducati has finally revealed its plans to come up with electric motorcycles. <https://digit.in/feb19-39>



10 best 'Shot on iPhone'

Apple is looking for outstanding photographs for a Shot on iPhone Challenge. To participate share your pics as #ShotOniPhone. <https://digit.in/feb19-40>



A paragraph from 'Consider the Consequences' showing how the story handled branching.

at nine crucial points in the storyline. There were essentially two cuts of the film which converged in the narrative at nine points, where the choice was brought to life by simply switching the lens cap between two projectors running each cut separately. Innovation in this medium was fairly limited at that point.

On the other hand, innovation was underway in another area. Games of the same era suffered huge limitations in terms of graphics and looked towards using the vast storage capacity of LaserDisc and live-action or animated video to overcome the same. What made these games a part of the interactive storytelling camp was



How Kinoautomat handled interactivity. The red and green indications around the screen show how the voting went, with each light representing one vote.

the multiple storylines playing out depending on user actions. Notable names include *Dragon's Lair* and *Space Ace*. While the novelty factor of such games/interactive movies was beginning to wear off by the 80s, innovation was far from over. The world of gaming was destined for far more interactivity in the years to come.

GAMES

While there's a lot of debate about the exact definition of interactive movies, the extent of branching storylines through interactivity that eventually became possible in gaming renders the debate inconsequential. The rising popularity of personal computers, consoles and the internet in the 90s made people more conducive towards experiencing all kinds of stories, especially interactive ones, from the comfort of their homes. When it comes to gaming, branching storylines are mostly seen in two primary formats - visual novels and RPGs.

Visual novels are more interactive than CYOA books and interactive movies, but less than full-fledged games. As a format, it is widely attributed to have originated in Japan, and usually features dialogue and other decisions mostly taken on static screens, although animated versions are known to exist as well. Recent notable examples include *Nine Hours, Nine Persons, Nine Doors* and *Zero Escape: Virtue's Last Reward*. Both feature multiple endings and take into account decisions taken earlier in the game to determine player actions later.



A screenshot from *Nine Hours, Nine Persons, Nine Doors*, a recent, acclaimed visual novel

Second Story, released for the original PlayStation in 1998 with as many as 86 possible endings! Over time, recent games like the *Mass Effect* series, *Dragon Age* series and more have had player choices influence game experience not only during the current game but even in the sequels being played with the same profile.

FUTURE OF INTERACTIVE STORYTELLING

For reasons too widely known today, people are consuming more video content than ever - on their laptops, smartphones and multiple other screens around them. These devices offer a unique opportunity beyond television and movie theatres. Audiences are typically used to placing themselves in front of a TV or a movie screen and doing nothing. On the other hand, our experiences with smart devices are usually more interactive.

If Netflix's *Bandersnatch* wasn't a first, it could definitely be a turning point. The future of entertainment is not necessarily interactive, but with technology like gaze detection, gesture control, voice control, combined with the virtual reality we could be looking at one where interactive storytelling is more immersive. 



If you just can't recall where you've seen *Dragon's Lair*, we'd suggest you rewatch *Stranger Things* Season 2.

RPG games with branching storylines differ from visual novels only in the fact that they contain more RPG elements, like character selection, quests and more. These factors also influence the branching storylines. *Might and Magic VII: For Blood and Honor* (1999) would be an early, but quite limited, example, falling short of more stellar options such as *Star Ocean: The*